

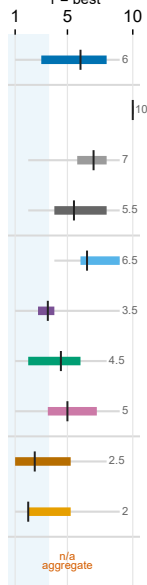
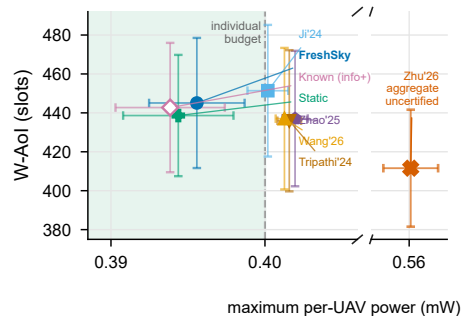
(a) Paired improvement matrix + rank stability

cell = mean [95% CI]; + FreshSky better; * CI excludes 0

	$d = 2$	$d = 4$	$d = 8$
FreshSky	REF paired anchor	REF paired anchor	REF paired anchor
Conservative age	+15.9 [+14.1, +17.7]	+27.0 [+25.3, +28.7]	+40.5 [+38.6, +42.5]
Max-Age	+3.9 [+1.9, +5.8]	+1.1 [-0.9, +3.1]	-0.7 [-2.7, +1.2]
Round-Robin	+2.8 [+1.2, +4.3]	+0.8 [-0.7, +2.3]	-1.3 [-2.9, +0.4]
Ji'24 greedy	+2.2 [+0.8, +3.6]	+1.4 [+0.3, +2.5]	+1.0 [-0.4, +2.4]
Zhao'25 MW-E	-0.2 [-1.7, +1.3]	-2.0 [-3.6, -0.4]	-3.7 [-5.2, -2.3]
Static DPP-MC	-0.6 [-2.0, +0.7]	-1.4 [-2.6, -0.1]	-0.9 [-2.0, +0.2]
Known transition	-0.6 [-2.0, +0.8]	-0.5 [-1.8, +0.7]	-1.9 [-3.2, -0.6]
Tripathi'24 WI	+0.3 [-1.7, +2.2]	-2.5 [-5.0, -0.0]	-3.9 [-6.1, -1.6]
Wang'26 PORMAB	-0.6 [-2.5, +1.3]	-2.2 [-4.2, -0.2]	-4.0 [-5.7, -2.3]
Zhu'26 agg.-DPP	-8.3 [-10.4, -6.1]	-8.1 [-10.3, -6.0]	-7.4 [-9.5, -5.3]

rank @ $d = 4$

1 = best

**(b) $d = 4$ contract plane****(c) Shift boundary: paired pre/post**